



FUNDING PROPOSAL

A PERMANENT HOME ON THE WATER: ENGINEERED MOORING SYSTEM

An engineered, permitted mooring so Comanche can stay put, safely, in all seasons.

\$360,000

TOTAL REQUEST

Executive summary

The Foundation will design, permit and install a permanent, engineered mooring system sized for an 800-ton historic vessel in protected Puget Sound waters, replacing the current cycle of temporary anchorages and state-mandated moves. A permanent mooring gives Comanche a stable address, ends recurring relocation costs and risk, and makes scheduled public access and volunteer work days possible.

Statement of need

Without long-term moorage, Comanche lives at anchor and must reposition under Washington DNR anchorage rules, each move burning fuel at roughly \$100 per mile and requiring a full volunteer crew. Every relocation is a weather-dependent underway evolution for an 80-year-old ship. Unstable moorage is the single largest operational risk the Foundation faces: it disrupts volunteer schedules, prevents advertised open-ship days, complicates insurance and makes multi-year program planning impossible.

Project description

Scope: (1) site selection and bathymetric/geotechnical survey; (2) stamped mooring design by a marine engineer, sized for vessel displacement, wind and current loads; (3) permitting — Washington DNR aquatic-lands authorization, WDFW Hydraulic Project Approval, U.S. Army Corps Section 10, SEPA and local shoreline permits; (4) fabrication and installation of the mooring (anchor system, chain, swivels, surface buoy) by crane barge and dive crew; (5) a three-year inspection and maintenance reserve. The Foundation will pursue the site in coordination with the host jurisdiction and tribal governments with treaty interests in the area.

Goals & measurable objectives

- Stamped mooring design and all permits obtained.
- Mooring installed and load-tested; vessel secured at the new site.
- Relocation moves reduced from several per year to zero routine moves.
- Published open-ship schedule made possible by a fixed location.

- Three-year inspection regime funded and documented.

Timeline

Months 1–3	Site selection, survey, engineering design.
Months 3–12	Permit applications and agency review (permitting is the long pole).
Months 12–15	Hardware fabrication; installation window scheduled around fish-work windows.
Month 15	Installation, load test, vessel moved to mooring.
Years 2–3	Annual dive inspection and maintenance from reserve.

Budget

Bathymetric and geotechnical site survey	\$18,000
Marine engineering — stamped mooring design and load analysis	\$24,000
Permitting: DNR lease/authorization, WDFW HPA, Corps Sec. 10, SEPA, shoreline (incl. consultant and fees)	\$38,000
Mooring hardware: anchor system, chain, swivels, hardware, buoy	\$72,000
Installation: crane barge, tug, dive crew, load test	\$60,000
Aquatic-lands lease and permit fees, 3 years	\$18,000
Inspection and maintenance reserve, 3 years	\$21,000
Insurance rider for installation and first year	\$9,000
Direct costs	\$260,000
Project management & administration (10%)	\$26,000
Contingency (25%)	\$71,500
Total project cost	\$357,500
Amount requested (rounded)	\$360,000

Budget lines are order-of-magnitude planning figures for a 133 ft / 295 GT steel vessel on Puget Sound, deliberately conservative so the funded scope can be delivered in full; they are replaced with vendor quotes at application. Unused contingency is returned or reallocated with funder approval. Partial funding is welcome and combinable with other sources.

In-kind and match. Volunteer crew for vessel moves and installation support, board permitting liaison, in-kind dive inspections from volunteer divers where qualified.

Evaluation

- Permits issued (copies on file).
- Installation report and load-test certificate from installer.
- Relocation count and moorage cost per year, before vs. after.

Funder fit

- Washington RCO / Boating Facilities Program (partner-sponsored)
- Port and county community grants
- Maritime Washington NHA
- Corporate maritime sponsors

- Open-ship days held at the fixed location in year one.
- Private foundations with preservation or waterfront focus

Sustainability

Annual inspection and lease costs (~\$13,000/yr after the funded period) are budgeted into the Foundation's operating plan and partially offset by savings from eliminated relocation moves.

Organization overview

Tug Comanche Historical Rescue Foundation (EIN 39-5018917) is a Washington nonprofit based in Auburn, Washington, listed on the IRS Publication 78 data list as eligible to receive tax-deductible charitable contributions (deductibility code PC). The Foundation preserves the historic vessel Comanche — laid down in 1944 as the U.S. Navy ocean tug ATA-202, later USS Wampanoag and Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 — and operates her as a living platform for maritime heritage, hands-on education, youth mentorship, restoration-skills exposure, veteran and mariner storytelling, Puget Sound stewardship, and community service. Comanche is one of the last operational WWII museum ships in the world, still moving under her own power with an all-volunteer crew. The organization is governed by a volunteer board of directors and delivers its programs through volunteers, maritime-trades mentors and community partners.

Vessel history & significance

Comanche is a rare surviving example of a WWII-era U.S. Navy auxiliary ocean tug. Completed in 1944 and commissioned as ATA-202, she was named USS Wampanoag in 1948 and later served as the U.S. Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 before becoming known as Comanche. Her current U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Documentation (Official Number 647250; IMO 8991786) records a steel-hulled, mechanically propelled vessel of 133.4 feet registered length, 33.1-foot breadth, 17.7-foot depth and 295 gross tons (ITC), hailing port Seattle, Washington. She is propelled by two Cleveland Diesel 12-cylinder diesel-electric main engines driving a single screw, and holds a world record as the last ship still steered by deck-tube chain rudder control.

Legal & operating boundary. Comanche does not hold a U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Inspection for commercial passenger service. No grant funds, fees or donations are or will be used for paid carriage, charters, towing, freight or any underway commercial service. Public programs take place alongside the pier; cruises occur only in partnership with other nonprofit and community organizations, never as a charter, and the Foundation retains control of the vessel at all times.

Contact: Wesley Weaver, Secretary — info@tug202.org — tug202.org · The web version of this proposal, with the latest figures, is at tug202.org/grants/year-round-mooring.